

HCR\Unknown\shell:
“notepad”

HCR\Unknown\shell\notepad:
“Open Using The Wonderful Notepad Application” (or whatever you want!)

HCR\Unknown\shell\notepad\command:
“C:\WINDOWS\NOTEPAD.EXE %1”

Now, not only will double-clicking a file with an unknown extension cause it to be opened in Notepad, you’ll also get “Open Using The Wonderful Notepad Application” in the context menu when you right-click the file. When you choose that option, the file, well, opens in Notepad!

Don’t Hog The Limelight

It’s irritating when an application steals focus. You’re typing, and all of a sudden you find you’re not... because there’s some other window that’s blinking blue on the taskbar, begging to be noticed. Here’s how to prevent windows from stealing focus.

Navigate to:
HCU\Control Panel\Desktop

Create or modify the DWORD called `ForegroundLockTimeout`. Give it a value of... no, not 1 or 0; the value to give this DWORD is 00030D40. This is in hexadecimal, so when you get the “modify” box, make sure “Hexadecimal” is selected.

I’ll Read My Mail, Thank You

In XP, you get a message at the logon screen that tells you how many unread mail messages you have. This isn’t very useful: if you do care how many unread mails you have, you’ll probably be getting to your Inbox soon enough! It can be a mild irritant if you log off and back on frequently, and you see that same number there. Anyway, here’s how you can get rid of the intimation altogether.